

Vision & Hearing Care

Need glasses, an eye exam, or hearing aids but can't afford them? Nonprofits and programs provide free or low-cost vision and hearing care. Below are trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Hearing aids and eye care are expensive, but real help exists — including free eyeglasses and low-cost hearing aids. Note: many basic hearing aids can now be bought over the counter without an exam.

1 Free & Low-Cost Eye Care

Programs that provide free eye exams and glasses for people who qualify.

☐ EyeCare America

Free eye exams for eligible seniors and those at risk of eye disease, through volunteer ophthalmologists.

→ www.aao.org/eyecare-america

☐ VSP — Eyes of Hope

Free eye exam and glasses gift certificates for people in need.

→ eyesofhope.vsp.com

☐ New Eyes

Helps people get free new eyeglasses through a voucher program.

→ new-eyes.org

2 Low-Cost Glasses

Affordable ways to get glasses if you have a prescription.

☐ Low-Cost Online Eyeglasses

Sites like Zenni and EyeBuyDirect sell glasses from around \$10–\$20 with your prescription.

→ www.zennioptical.com

☐ Lions Club — Eyeglass Help

Local Lions Clubs collect and provide eyeglasses to people in need. Ask 211 or your local club.

→ **Ask 211 or your local Lions Club**

3 Hearing Care & Aids

Free and low-cost help for hearing tests and hearing aids.

☐ Over-the-Counter Hearing Aids

Basic hearing aids are now sold over the counter for mild-to-moderate loss — far cheaper than prescription ones. Available at pharmacies and online.

→ www.fda.gov/medical-devices/hearing-aids/otc-hearing-aids-what-you-should-know

☐ Hearing Charities of America

Helps provide hearing aids to people who can't afford them.

→ www.hearingcharities.org

☐ Lions Club — Hearing Aid Help

Many local Lions Clubs help with hearing aids. Ask 211 or your local club.

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4 For Seniors, Veterans & Kids

Targeted help through public programs.

☐ Medicaid & Medicare Vision/Hearing

Medicaid often covers eye and hearing care; Medicare covers some. Check your benefits.

→ www.medicare.gov/coverage/eye-exams

☐ VA Vision & Hearing — Veterans

Eligible veterans can receive eye and hearing care, including hearing aids, through the VA.

→ www.va.gov/health-care/about-va-health-benefits

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Be cautious of high-pressure sales for expensive hearing aids — for many people, the new over-the-counter options work well at a fraction of the price. Always get a written eyeglass prescription so you can shop around.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Ask your eye doctor for a copy of your prescription — they're required to give it to you — then buy glasses cheaply online. For hearing, try over-the-counter aids before spending thousands.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need local vision or hearing help?

This guide covers national programs. For local clinics, Lions Clubs, and vision/hearing help near you, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we'll help you find the closest options.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
